

General Guidelines

Introduction.....	3
Purpose of Search Quality Rating.....	3
Page Quality.....	4
Understanding Websites and Web Pages.....	4
Important Definitions:.....	4
Understanding the Purpose of a Web Page.....	4
Your Money or Your Life (YMYL) Topics.....	5
Webpage Content.....	6
Overall Page Quality Rating.....	7
Page Quality Considerations.....	7
Quality of the Main Content.....	8
Reputation of the Website and Content Creators.....	8
Examples of Reputation Information.....	10
Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, and Trust (E-E-A-T).....	10
YMYL Topics: Experience or Expertise?.....	11
Lowest Page Quality.....	12
Types of Lowest Quality Pages.....	12
Examples of Lowest Quality Pages.....	15
Low Page Quality.....	16
Indications of a Low Quality Page:.....	16
Examples of Low Quality Pages.....	18
Medium Page Quality.....	19
Examples of Medium Quality Pages.....	19
High Page Quality.....	20
High Quality Main Content.....	20
High Quality EEAT.....	21
Examples of High Quality Pages.....	21
Highest Quality Pages.....	22
Very High Quality Main Content.....	22
Very Positive Reputation.....	22
Very High Level of E-E-A-T.....	23
Examples of Highest Quality Page.....	23
Ratings for Forums and Q&A Pages.....	24
Needs Met.....	26
Understanding Search Users, Queries, and Results.....	26
Important Rating Definitions and Ideas.....	26
Understanding the Query.....	27
Locale and User Location.....	27
Queries with Multiple Meanings.....	27
Query Meanings Can Change Over Time.....	28
Understanding User Intent.....	29
1. Know and Know Simple Queries.....	29

2. Do Queries.....	29
3. Website Queries.....	30
4. Visit-in-Person Queries and User Location.....	30
Understanding Result Blocks.....	31
Web Search Result Blocks.....	31
Special Content Result Blocks.....	31
Needs Met Rating Guideline.....	33
Rating Using the Needs Met Scale.....	33
Landing Page Needs Met Ratings and Block Content Needs Met Ratings.....	33
Fully Meets (FullyM).....	34
Examples of Fully Meets (FullyM) Result Blocks.....	34
Examples of Queries that Cannot Have Fully Meets Results.....	35
Highly Meets (HM).....	36
Examples of Highly Meets (HM) Result Blocks.....	36
Moderately Meets (MM).....	37
Examples of Moderately Meets (MM) Result Blocks.....	37
Slightly Meets (SM).....	38
Examples of Slightly Meets (SM) Result Blocks.....	38
Fails to Meet (FailsM).....	39
Examples of Fails to Meet (FailsM) Result Blocks.....	39
The Relationship between Page Quality and Needs Met.....	40
Rating Porn, Foreign Language, and Did Not Load Results.....	41
Porn Flag.....	41
• Needs Met Rating for Clear Non-Porn Intent Queries.....	41
• Needs Met Rating for Possible Porn Intent Queries.....	41
• Needs Met Rating for Clear Porn Intent Queries.....	41
Foreign Flag.....	41
• Needs Met Rating for Foreign Language Results.....	42
Did Not Load Flag.....	43
Rating Queries with Both Website and Visit-in-Person Intent.....	44
Needs Met Rating and Freshness.....	45
Misspelled and Mistyped Queries.....	46
Rating Dictionary and Encyclopedia Results for Different Queries.....	46
Duplicate Results.....	47

Introduction

As a Search Quality Rater (Raters), you will work on many different types of rating projects. This guideline primarily covers Page Quality (PQ) rating and Needs Met (NM) rating; however, the concepts are also important for many other types of rating tasks.



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Purpose of Search Quality Rating

As a Search Quality Rater, you will help evaluate search engine quality around the world. Good search engines give results that are helpful for people in their own specific language and locale.

No single rating can directly impact how a particular webpage, website, or result appears in Google Search, nor can it cause specific webpages, websites, or results to move up or down on the search results page. Using ratings to position results on the search results page would not be feasible, as humans could never individually rate each page on the open web.

Instead, ratings are used to measure how effectively search engines are working to deliver helpful content to people around the world. Ratings are also used to improve search engines by providing examples of helpful and unhelpful results for different searches.

To be able to rate effectively, it is important that you are familiar with and comfortable using a search engine. We encourage you to be an expert in search! For example, experiment with using [operators](#) (e.g., quotes or a hyphen) in your searches or try using [advanced search options](#).

Page Quality

A Page Quality (PQ) rating task consists of a URL and a grid to record your observations as you explore the landing page and the website associated with the URL. The goal of PQ rating is to evaluate how well the page achieves its purpose.

Understanding Websites and Web Pages

Important Definitions:

- A **search engine** is a tool to help people find or interact with content available on the Internet.
- A **user** refers to a person trying to find information or accomplish a task on the Internet. Users are people from many different backgrounds, whose experiences and needs may differ from your own: people of all ages, genders, races, religions, political affiliations, etc.
- A **webpage** is connected to the World Wide Web and can be viewed or "visited" using a web browser (e.g., Chrome), a browser on your phone, or a search app.
- A **website** or site is a group of World Wide Web pages usually containing hyperlinks to each other and made available online by an individual, company, educational institution, government, or organization.
- A **homepage** of a website is the main page of the site. It is usually the first page that users see when the site loads. For example, <http://www.apple.com> is the homepage of the Apple site. You can usually find the homepage of a website by clicking on a "home" link or logo link on subpages of a website.
- A **website owner** is the person, company, or organization who is responsible for a website.
- A **content creator** is the individual(s) or entity (business, organization, etc.) who created the content on a webpage.
- **Generative AI** is a type of machine learning (ML) model that can take what it has learned from the examples it has been provided to create new content, such as text, images, music, and code. Learn more [here](#).

Understanding the Purpose of a Web Page

The purpose of a page is the reason or reasons why the page was created. Some pages are created merely to make money, with little or no effort to help people. Some pages are even created to harm users. The first step in understanding a page is figuring out its purpose.

Why is it important to determine the purpose of the page for PQ rating?

- The goal of PQ rating is to determine how well a page achieves its purpose. In order to assign a rating, you must understand the purpose of the page and sometimes the website.
- Websites and pages should be created to help people. If that is not the case, or if the page has no purpose, a rating of Lowest may be warranted.

As long as the page is created to help people, we will not consider any particular page purpose or type to be higher quality than another. For example, encyclopedia pages are not necessarily higher quality than humor pages.

Common helpful or beneficial page purposes include (but are not limited to):

- To share information about a topic.
- To share a personal experience, perspective, or feelings on a topic.
- To share pictures, videos, or other forms of media.
- To demonstrate a personal talent or skill.
- To express an opinion or point of view.
- To entertain.
- To offer products or services.
- To allow people to post questions for other users to answer.
- To allow people to share files or to download software.
- To allow people to support a charity or other cause they care about.

Your Money or Your Life (YMYL) Topics

Some topics online have a high risk of harm because content about these topics could significantly impact the health, financial stability, or safety of people, or the welfare or well-being of society. We call these topics “Your Money or Your Life” or YMYL.

YMYL topics may significantly impact or harm one or more of the following:

- the person who is directly viewing or using the content
- other people who are affected by the person who viewed the content
- groups of people or society affected by the actions of people who viewed the content

YMYL topics can directly and significantly impact people’s health, financial stability or safety, or the welfare or well-being of society, because of the following reasons:

- There is clear and present harm directly associated with the topic. For example, self-harm, criminal acts, and violent extremism.
- The topic could cause harm if content is not accurate and trustworthy. Even mild inaccuracies or less reliable sources could significantly impact people. For example, Symptoms of a heart attack, How to invest money, What to do if there is an earthquake.

There are four Categories of YMYL Harm:

- **YMYL Health or Safety:** Topics that could harm mental health, physical health, emotional health or any form of safety (physical safety or online safety).
- **YMYL Financial Security:** Topics that could damage a person's ability to support themselves and their families
- **YMYL Government, Civics & Society:** Topics that could negatively impact groups of people, issues of public interest, trust in public institutions, election and voting information, and any other informational topics about government, civics or society that impacts people's lives.
- **YMYL Other:** Topics that could hurt people or negatively impact welfare or well-being of society.

It's possible to imagine a hypothetical harmful page for any non-harmful topic, for example, someone could build a page that has a malicious computer virus download. However, for a specific topic to be YMYL, the topic itself must potentially impact people's health, financial stability, or safety, or the welfare or well-being of society.

Many or most topics are not YMYL and do not require a high level of accuracy or trust to prevent harm. Because YMYL assessment is a spectrum, it may be helpful to think of topics as clear YMYL, definitely not YMYL or something in between. Pages on clear YMYL topics require the most scrutiny for Page Quality rating.

Webpage Content

- **Main Content (MC)** is any part of the page that directly helps the page achieve its purpose. Main Content is (or should be!) the reason the page exists. Main Content can be text, images, videos, page features (e.g., calculators, games). Examples: [Main Content - News Homepage](#); [Main Content - Shopping Page](#); [Main Content - Currency Converter](#)
- **Supplementary Content (SC)** contributes to a good user experience on the page, but does NOT directly help the page achieve its purpose. SC is an important part of the user experience. One common type of SC is navigation links that allow users to visit other parts of the website. Examples: [SC - News Article](#); [SC - Shopping Page](#); [SC - Blog Post Page](#)
- **Advertisements/Monetization (Ads)** may contribute to a good user experience.) is content and/or links that are displayed for the purpose of monetizing (making money from) the page. The presence or absence of Ads is not by itself a reason for a High or Low quality rating. Examples: [Ads - News Article](#); [Ads - Blog Post Page](#)

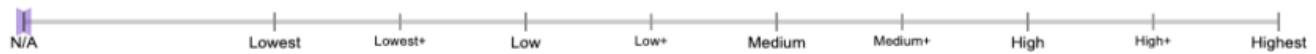
Overall Page Quality Rating

Here are the high-level steps of Page Quality rating:

1. Assess the true purpose of the page. If the website or page has a harmful purpose or is designed to deceive people about its true purpose, it should be rated **Lowest**.
2. Assess the potential of the page to cause harm. Websites or pages that are harmful to people or society, untrustworthy, or spammy as defined in these guidelines should be rated **Lowest**.
3. Otherwise, the PQ rating is based on how well the page achieves its purpose.

Important: There are harmful pages that are seemingly “official”, “expert”, or “authoritative”. Any type of website may have pages with harmful Main Content, from user-uploaded videos and forum posts to harmful products sold online to pages to pages that mimic the look of scientific papers or encyclopedia entries. All pages should be evaluated for harm.

On Page Quality rating tasks, you will use the Page Quality sliding scale (slider) to assign the overall PQ rating. The slider looks like this:



Page Quality Considerations

Consideration	Why it's Important for Page Quality Rating
Purpose of the page	If the page has a harmful purpose, or if it is designed to deceive people about its true purpose or who is responsible for the content, it should be rated Lowest .
Potential for the page or website to cause harm	Websites or pages that are harmful to people or society, untrustworthy, or spammy as described in these guidelines should be rated Lowest .
Topic of the page and the extent to which that topic is YMYL	The topic of the page helps determine the standards for your overall PQ assessment. Pages on YMYL topics have higher standards than pages on non-YMYL topics.
The type of website	Different types of websites have different expectations for PQ rating. For example, PQ expectations may differ for: • Small hobbyist websites vs. large corporate websites • Websites involving financial transactions vs. websites that do not require payment or collect personal information
Information provided by the website and content creator	While the information that websites and content creators provide about themselves isn't always trustworthy, it can provide an important starting point.
Quality of the Main Content	Consider the extent to which the Main Content is satisfying and helps the page achieve its purpose.
The title of the page	Descriptive Main Content titles that summarize the page allow people to make informed decisions about what pages to visit.
The role of Ads and SC on the page	Consider the ways how the Ads and SC contribute to the experience of the page.

Consideration	Why it's Important for Page Quality Rating
	Remember: Many websites need monetization to share content with users. The presence or absence of Ads alone is not a consideration for PQ rating
Reputation of the website and content creator	Research the reputation of the website and the content creator to learn about how others view the website and who is behind it.
Trustworthiness of the page	Experience, Expertise and Authoritativeness can help with your assessment of Trust. Some types of pages require a high level of trust.

Quality of the Main Content

The Main Content plays a major role in determining how well a page achieves its purpose. For most pages, the quality of the Main Content can be determined by the amount of **effort, originality, and talent or skill** that went into the creation of the content. For informational pages and pages on YMYL topics, **accuracy** and consistency with well established expert consensus is important.

- **Effort:** Consider the extent to which a human being actively worked to create satisfying content. Efforts may be direct, such as a person translating a poem from one language to another, designing page functionality or building systems that power a webpage.

On the other hand, the automatic creation of thousands of pages by running existing freely available content through existing translation software without any oversight, manual curation, etc., would not be considered to have effort.

- **Originality:** Consider the extent to which the content offers unique, original content that is not available on other websites. If other websites have similar content, consider whether the page is the original source. Main Content should not be copied from another source.
- **Talent or Skill:** Consider the extent to which the content is created with enough talent and skill to provide a satisfying experience for people who visit the page.
- **Accuracy:** For informational pages, consider the extent to which the content is factually accurate. For pages on YMYL topics, consider the extent to which the content is accurate and consistent with well-established expert consensus.

For each page you evaluate, read the article, watch the video, examine the pictures, use the calculator, play the online game, etc. Remember that Main Content also includes page features and functionality, so test the page out.

Reputation of the Website and Content Creators

Understanding the reputation of both the website and the content creator (when they differ) is a crucial component of PQ rating. Reputation research should be conducted based on the specific topic of the page, as a website may be trustworthy for one type of content but unreliable for another.

Researching reputation also helps identify what a website or content creator is best known for. It's important to note that companies and individuals often create content across multiple platforms, so researchers should investigate the underlying company or content creator rather than just individual platforms. Reputation research is

particularly critical for identifying untrustworthy websites and content creators, as professionally presented content may hide scams, fraud, or other harmful elements that only surface through proper investigation.

- **Reputation of the website:** A website's reputation is based on the experience of real users and the opinions of people who are experts. Many websites are eager to tell users how great they are. Your job is to independently evaluate the Page Quality of the website, not just accept information that appears on one or two pages of the website without further verification. Look for independent reviews, references, recommendations by experts, news articles, and other sources of credible information about the website.

For YMYL topics, the reputation of a website should be judged by what experts in the field have to say. Recommendations from expert sources, such as professional societies, are strong evidence of a positive reputation.

- **Customer Reviews as Reputation Information:** Customer reviews can be helpful for assessing the reputation of a store, business, or any website that offers products or services to users. However, you should interpret customer reviews with care, particularly if there are only a few. Keep in mind to be skeptical of both positive and negative reviews; try to find as many reviews as possible; and read the content of the reviews, not just the number rating.
- **How to Search for Reputation Information about a Website:**
 1. Identify the “homepage” of the website. For example, for the IBM website, [ibm.com](https://www.ibm.com) is the homepage. You may need to identify the content creator, if it is different from that of the overall website.
 2. Using [ibm.com](https://www.ibm.com) as an example, try one or more of the following searches on Google:
 - [ibm -site:ibm.com] - A search for IBM that excludes pages on [ibm.com](https://www.ibm.com).
 - ibm reviews -site:ibm.com] - A search for reviews of IBM that excludes pages on [ibm.com](https://www.ibm.com)
 3. Look for articles, references, recommendations by experts, and other credible information written by people about the website.
 4. Make sure the information you find is appropriate for judging the reputation of the website. For example, reputation information for YMYL topics should come from sources that have expertise in the associated YMYL topic.
- **Reputation of the Content Creators:** Biographical information articles and online discussions serve as valuable sources of reputation information for content creators. Content creators working in journalistic, scientific, academic, or other traditionally professional capacities typically have more formal reputation information available, as online credibility is often essential for their professional success.

Influencers and other individual content creators who earn income through social media platforms also have reputation information available, ranging from biographical details and news articles to less formal sources such as comments from other influencers in their fields.

For non-professional content creators, including ordinary people who post on social media or forums, informal reputation information can often be found directly on the page itself through comments or posts from other users, which can provide insight into what others think about a particular content creator.

- **What to Do When You Find No Reputation Information:** You should expect to find some reputation information for large websites and well-known content creators. However, small websites, local businesses, and community organizations may have little or no reputation information, which is not indicative of quality as many rely on word of mouth.

A lack of reputation about people who post personal content is neither positive nor negative. When reputation information is unavailable for a website or content creator, pay extra attention to other PQ considerations, especially when assessing pages on YMYL topics.

Examples of Reputation Information

Website	Reputation Information	Description
annualcreditreport.com	Wikipedia article on annualcreditreport.com Reputable article on annualcreditreport.com	Positive reputation information: Users in the U.S. can obtain free credit reports on this website by providing their Social Security Number. "AnnualCreditReport.com is the only federally mandated and authorized source for obtaining a free credit report."
Site selling children's jungle gym	Negative review on a business review Negative news article	Extremely negative reputation information: This website appears to be a perfectly fine-looking store; however, much evidence of negative reputation can be found. The business has a very low rating on a business review site. There is a news article about financial fraud.

Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, and Trust (E-E-A-T)

Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness and Trust (E-E-A-T) are all important considerations in PQ rating. The most important member at the center of the E-E-A-T family is Trust.



Trust: Consider the extent to which the page is accurate, honest, safe, and reliable.

Experience, Expertise and Authoritativeness are concepts that can support your assessment of Trust:

- **Experience:** Consider the extent to which the content creator has the necessary first-hand or life experience for the topic. For example, which would you trust: a product review from someone who has personally used the product or a "review" by someone who has not?
- **Expertise:** Consider the extent to which the content creator has the necessary knowledge or skill for the topic. For example, which would you trust for home electrical rewiring advice: a skilled electrician or an antique homes enthusiast.

- **Authoritativeness:** Consider the extent to which the content creator or the website is known as a go-to source for the topic. For example, the official government page for getting a passport is the unique, official, and authoritative source for passport renewal.

Trust is the most important member of the E-E-A-T family because untrustworthy pages have low E-E-A-T no matter how Experienced, Expert, or Authoritative they may seem.

When it comes to Page Quality rating, your assessment of E-E-A-T should be informed by one or more of the following:

- What the website or content creators say about themselves
- What others say about the website or content creators
- What is visible on the page, including the Main Content and sections such as reviews and comments:

Important: The website or content creator may not be a trustworthy source if there is a clear conflict of interest. For example, product reviews by people who own the product and share their experiences can be very valuable and trustworthy. However, "reviews" by the product manufacturer ("Our product is great!") or "reviews" from an influencer who is paid to promote the product are not as trustworthy due to the conflict of interest.

Finally, there are many aspects of Trust, some which are not captured by Experience, Expertise and Authoritativeness. Please consider other aspects in your overall Trust assessment, such as customer service information for online stores or peer-reviewed publications for academic authors. If a page is untrustworthy for any reason, it has low E-E-A-T,

YMYL Topics: Experience or Expertise?

Pages on YMYL topics can be created for a wide variety of different purposes. If the purpose of a page on a clear YMYL topic is to give information or offer advice, a high level of expertise may be required for the page to be trustworthy.

However, sometimes pages on YMYL topics are created to share personal experiences, often regarding difficult life challenges. Factual information from experts and authoritative sources may not satisfy this need. Pages that share first-hand life experience on clear YMYL topics may be considered to have high E-E-A-T as long as the content is trustworthy, safe, and consistent with well-established expert consensus.

Here are some examples:

YMYL Topic	Valuable sharing of life Experience	Experts Information or advice
Sleep challenges when pregnant (YMYL Health or Safety)	Safe and non-medical tips for sleeping during pregnancy, provided by people who have personally struggled with this for example: how to use pillows to sleep comfortably in a position that is safe for babies	Sleep medications that are safe during pregnancy
Filling out tax forms (YMYL Financial Security)	A humorous video from a non-expert content creator about the frustration of doing taxes	Instructions on how to fill out tax forms
How to vote (YMYL Society)	A social media post by an ordinary citizen describing why they personally believe it's important to vote in local elections	Information about who is eligible to vote or how to register to vote

Lowest Page Quality

Lowest quality pages are untrustworthy, deceptive, harmful to people or society, or have other highly undesirable characteristics. The considerations for Lowest quality include quality of the Main Content, reputation, E-E-A-T, etc., but there are special checks you will need to complete first.

As a reminder, here are the steps for doing PQ rating:

1. Assess the true purpose of the page. If the website or page has a harmful purpose or is designed to deceive people about its true purpose, it should be rated Lowest.
2. Assess the potential of the page to cause harm as described in these guidelines. Websites or pages that are harmful to people or society, untrustworthy, or spammy should receive the Lowest rating.
3. Otherwise, the PQ rating is based on how well the page achieves its purpose using the criteria outlined in these guidelines.

Types of Lowest Quality Pages

There are many different shapes and forms that Lowest pages can take. These categories can overlap (e.g. pages that contain Harmfully Misleading Information are also Untrustworthy).

1. Harmful to Self or Other Individuals:

Pages that encourage, depict, incite or directly cause physical, mental, emotional or financial harm to self or other individuals.

Harmful to Self or Other Individuals	NOT Harmful to Self or Other Individuals
• Detailed instructions on how to commit suicide • Serious death threats • Exposing personal information belonging to others with malicious intent (i.e., “doxxing”) • How-to information that describes how to commit violent acts in an easy-to-replicate way	• Depictions of violence in an action movie • A news story about violent events • Educational content that may depict violence or gross imagery • An explanation of scams

2. Harmful to Specified Groups:

Use the Lowest rating for pages that promote, condone, or incite hatred against a Specified Group of people. A Specified Group is a group of people that can be defined on the basis of:

- Age (e.g., older adults)
- Caste (e.g., Dalits)
- Disability (e.g., people who are blind)
- Ethnicity (e.g., Roma)
- Gender Identity and Expression (e.g., transgender people)
- Immigration Status (e.g., student visa holders)
- Religion (e.g., Christians)
- Sex/Gender (e.g., men)
- Sexual Orientation (e.g., lesbians)
- Veteran Status (e.g., Marines)
- Victims of a major violent event and their kin (e.g., victims of the Holocaust)
- Any other characteristic that is associated with systemic discrimination or marginalization (e.g., refugees, people experiencing homelessness)
- Nationality (e.g., Italians)
- Race (e.g., Asians)

The tone of the harmful content must be either serious (i.e., not joking or satirical) or mean-spirited (i.e., with an intent to demean or promote intolerance) to be considered Harmful to Specified Groups. Comedy or artistic expression related to a Specified Group should not be considered harmful unless it is clearly mean-spirited or has other clear harmful impact.

Educational pages, historical documentations, news stories, or other pages that have a beneficial purpose of informing society should not be considered Harmful to Specified Groups.

Harmful to Specified Groups	NOT Harmful to Specified Groups
- Promotes intolerance by demonstrating a staunch unwillingness to allow for the views, beliefs, or behavior of a Specified Group - Implies that one Specified Group is superior or inferior to another	- A historical documentary of WWII featuring speeches from Nazi leaders - A stand-up comedy routine that plays off of stereotypes in a way that is not mean-spirited

3. Harmfully Misleading Information

Pages should be considered to contain Harmfully Misleading Information when they contain at least one of the following:

Type of Harmfully Misleading Information	Description	Examples
Harmful and clearly inaccurate information	Content that can be refuted by straightforward and widely accepted facts	- False claims that a world leader died - False dates for an election
Harmful claims that contradict well-established expert consensus	Content that is inconsistent with positions, facts, or findings that are widely agreed upon by authorities in the relevant field	- Claims that lemons cure cancer - Claims that buying lottery tickets is a guaranteed way to save for retirement
Harmful unsubstantiated theories/claims	Information that isn't based on real facts or proof, especially when it could make people lose trust in government and public organizations. This includes conspiracy theories that have been proven wrong or are too far-fetched to be believable.	- Claims that the 9-11 attacks were planned by the U.S. government - Claims that world leaders are lizard people

Use the Lowest rating for pages that mislead people in ways that can cause harm to people and society.

However, note that some types of information are subjective, debatable, unverifiable, or inconsequential. For example, pages should not be considered to contain Harmfully Misleading Information if they exclusively contain:

- Non-YMYL content created with a clear entertainment purpose, containing no hard claims of factual accuracy and are not harmful to people or society.e.g. fiction, parody, astrology, folklore, myths, and urban legends.
- Reviews, opinions, or value-based judgments about a product, restaurant, book/movie/TV show
- Inaccurate information about a trivial topic (e.g., inaccuracies in the height of a celebrity)

4. Untrustworthy Webpages or Websites

The Lowest rating should be used for pages or websites you strongly suspect are engaging in deceptive or malicious practices.

Untrustworthy websites benefit the organization rather than users, or actively harm visitors through scams and malware. If you suspect deception, investigate the site's reputation. A single odd page may be harmless, but any pattern of deception or manipulation should prompt you to assign the lowest rating and leave immediately for your safety.

Pages with the following characteristics should be considered Untrustworthy:

- Multiple or significant factual inaccuracies on an informational page which would cause users to lose trust in the webpage as a reliable source of information
- Inadequate information about the website or content creator for its purpose
- Lowest E-E-A-T or Lowest reputation
- Deceptive purpose, deceptive page design, or deceptive intent
- Deliberately obstructed or obscured Main Content
- Characteristics of scams, malicious downloads, or other harmful behavior
- Any webpage or website designed to manipulate people into actions that benefit the website or other organization while causing harm to self, others, or Specified Groups

5. Spammy Webpages

This section describes characteristics of spam or spam-like pages that should be rated Lowest. [The Google Search Web Spam Policies](#) page is a good reference to learn more about different spam techniques. If you recognize any of these spam techniques on a page, use the Lowest rating.

Characteristics of Spammy webpages include:

- **Cannot Determine a Purpose, No Main Content, Little Main Content, Lowest Quality Main Content or No Added Value Main Content:** All pages should be created with sufficient Main Content quality so that the page can achieve its purpose. However, some pages are so lacking in Main Content that the purpose of the page itself is unclear or you may suspect the page is not actually created for people. If you cannot determine the purpose of a page due to the Main Content being gibberish or otherwise unusable, the PQ rating should be Lowest.
- **Hacked, Defaced, or Spammed Pages:** A hacked or defaced website is a site that has been modified without permission from the website owner(s).
- **Expired domain abuse:** An expired domain name is purchased and repurposed primarily to benefit the new website owner by hosting content that provides little to no value to users. For example, casino-related content on a former elementary school site. To confirm, look up the homepage on the [Internet Archive](#) to see if an obvious change has occurred.
- **Site reputation abuse:** Third-party content is published on a reputable website to manipulate search rankings. The practice exploits the host site's established authority and trust to rank

content that wouldn't normally perform well on its own. Essentially, it's piggybacking on a trusted domain's reputation to boost visibility in search results.

- **Scaled Content Abuse:** Creating an abundance of content with little effort or originality with no editing or manual curation is often the defining attribute of spammy websites.
- **Main Content Created with Little to No Effort, Little to No Originality, and Little to No Added Value for Website Visitors:** The Lowest rating applies if all or almost all of the Main Content on the page (including text, images, audio, videos) is copied, paraphrased, embedded, auto or AI generated, or reposted from other sources with little to no effort and little to no added value for visitors to the website. Google Search key phrases or sentences from the page to determine if it is copied.

Examples of Lowest Quality Pages

Webpage/Content	Lowest Quality Justification	Explanation
Lowest: Superiority of Specified Group	Harmful to Specified Groups • Promotes, condones, or incites hatred against a Specified Group of people • Lowest website reputation	Inciting hatred towards Specified Groups significantly harms members of those groups and society as a whole. This page is on a YMYL topic. This website has an extremely negative reputation for promoting white supremacy, antisemitism, Holocaust denial, etc
Lowest: Miley Cyrus is dead "news article" on a deceptive website	Harmfully Misleading Information, Untrustworthy • Contains clearly inaccurate information that can be refuted by facts • Deceptive page design	This website is designed to look like a news site and yet has deliberate factually inaccurate information. There is no information on who the content creator is. There is no date for the news article or date of death, which would be a key part of any standard reporting.
Lowest: Chicken recipes no Main Content This looks like a list of chicken recipes, but is actually a list of links that are ads.	Untrustworthy, Spammy • No Main Content • Deceptive page design • Content created with little to no effort, little to no originality, and little to no added value for website visitors	Main Content should be created to benefit people who come to the website. Pages without Main Content should be considered spammy. Pages with Ads that are designed to look like Main Content should be considered untrustworthy.
Lowest: Eating disorder encouragement	Harmful to Self or Other Individuals • Encourages physical, mental, emotional, or financial harm to self or others • Contains information that contradicts well-established expert consensus	Eating disorders and decisions to seek medical treatment significantly impact a person's health. This is a YMYL topic. This post encourages harmful behavior. "Proana" or pro-anorexia is a movement to view anorexia as a lifestyle choice, not a disease. Proana and similar "thinspiration" pages contradict well-established expert consensus.

Low Page Quality

Low quality pages do not achieve their purpose well as they are lacking in an important dimension. Low quality pages do not meet the standards for Lowest but may have milder undesirable characteristics.

To identify Low quality pages, consider the following:

- **The purpose of the page:** Low quality pages have a beneficial or non-harmful purpose.
- **The potential for the page to cause harm:** Low quality pages have either no potential to cause harm, or have some mild potential for harm but do not meet the standards for Lowest.
- **The topic of the page, the type of website, and the extent to which YMYL standards apply:** A page on any topic or any type of website may qualify for Low. Give special scrutiny to pages or websites needing a high level of trust, such as online stores, medical websites, or news.
- **Quality of the Main Content:** Main Content has inadequate effort, originality, talent, or skill necessary to achieve its purpose
- **Page Title:** The page title is slightly misleading, shocking, or exaggerated
- **The role of Ads and SC on the page:** The Ads or SC significantly distract from the use of the Main Content
- **Information provided by the website and content creator:** Unsatisfying amount of website information or information about the content creator for the purpose of the page.
- **Reputation:** A mildly negative reputation of the website or content creator.
- **E-E-A-T:** Inadequate level of E-E-A-T for the purpose of the page.

Indications of a Low Quality Page:

1. Lacking EEAT

Some examples include:

- Content creator lacking adequate experience. e.g. restaurant review written by someone who has never visited or eaten at the restaurant.
- Content creator lacking expertise. e.g. Skidiving instructions written by someone with no expertise in the subject
- The website or content creator is not an authoritative or trustworthy source for the topic of the page, e.g. tax form downloads provided on a cooking website.
- The page is not trustworthy, e.g. a shopping page with minimal customer service information

2. Low Quality Main Content

Main Content is Low quality if it is created without adequate effort, originality, talent, or skill necessary to achieve the purpose of the page in a satisfying way. Here are some examples:

Low Quality Main Content Examples	Why the Main Content is considered Low quality
A crafting tutorial page with instructions on how to make a basic craft and lots of unhelpful "filler" at the top, such as commonly known facts about the supplies needed or other non-crafting information.	Lacks adequate effort to clearly present the instructions to people hoping to make the craft.
A page titled "How many centimeters are in a meter?" with a large amount of off-topic and unhelpful content such that the very small amount of helpful information is hard to find.	Lacks effort, has excessive filler, lacks depth, and has only commonly known facts.

The **title** of the page is also part of the Main Content. Titles are important as they represent the page in search results and help users decide what to click on. A misleading title can lead to a poor search experience.

For example, a page titled "Is the World about to End? Mysterious Sightings of Sea Serpents Prompt Panic!", for an article about the remains of a dead fish on a beach.

3. Main Content is Created with Low Effort, Low Originality and Low Value for Website Visitors

Search users benefit from high-quality, original websites, but some pages simply repackage content from better sources with minimal effort or value. The rating system assigns "Lowest" when **all or nearly all** content is copied with no added value, and "Low" when **much** of the content is copied with minimal improvement efforts like basic editing or reformatting.

Common examples of low-quality content include social media reposts without meaningful discussion, pages of embedded videos or images with little commentary, and "best of" lists without original insights.

4. Filler

Sometimes, Main Content includes "filler" - low-effort content that adds little value and doesn't directly support the purpose of the page. Filler can artificially inflate content, creating a page that appears rich but lacks content website visitors find valuable.

Web site owners and content creators should place the most helpful and essential Main Content near the top of the page so that visitors can immediately access it. Filler can result in a poor experience for people who visit the page, especially if placed prominently ahead of helpful content for the purpose of the page.

A Low rating is appropriate if the page:

- Contains a large amount of low quality and unhelpful filler
- Contains a large amount visually prominent filler that makes it difficult to find the helpful Main Content

5. Distracting Ads/SC

Some ads, SC and [interstitial pages](#) make it difficult to use the Main Content. Pages with ads or features that significantly distract users or make it hard to access content should receive a Low rating, even if the Main Content is helpful. While simple pop-ups with easy-to-close buttons aren't overly distracting, ads that follow page scrolls or interstitials requiring app downloads are truly disruptive and interfere with the user experience.

The content of the Ads, SC, or other features may be distracting as well: sexually suggestive images such as [here](#), grotesque images such as [here](#), and sexually suggestive Ads on otherwise non-sexual pages are very distracting.

6. Mildly Negative Reputation of the Website or Content Creator

If the Main Content was created by a content creator who is using the website to host it, research the reputation of the content creator. Expect to find reputation information on well-known journalists, authors, social media influencers, professionals such as lawyers and doctors, etc. Pay attention when there is evidence of mildly negative—though not malicious or financially fraudulent—reputation. However, a lack of reputation information for ordinary people and lesser-known content creators is expected and is not a sign of low quality.

7. Unsatisfying Amount of Information about the Website or Content Creator

Most websites should clearly identify who created the content (individual, company, etc.), though usernames or aliases are acceptable, and for non-YMYL personal sites, an email or social media link may suffice. However, stores and financial transaction websites require higher levels of trust and contact information to help users resolve issues. Pages offering payment functionality or covering YMYL topics should receive a Low rating if they lack adequate customer service or creator information.

8. Exaggerated or Mildly Misleading Information about the Website or Content Creator

While deceptive information about a website or content creator warrants a Lowest rating, exaggerated or mildly misleading claims—such as overstated personal experience or expertise—should receive a Low rating. E-E-A-T (Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness) assessments must be based on the actual content, reputation research, and verifiable credentials rather than self-proclaimed expertise.

Examples of Low Quality Pages

Type of Webpage/Content	Low Quality Justification	Explanation
<u>Low: News</u> Article titled "Getting Rid Of Toxins After The Holiday Season"	• Unsatisfying Main Content for the purpose of the page • Main Content lacks accuracy or does not align with well-established expert consensus • Slightly misleading, shocking, or exaggerated title • Low E-E-A-T	The title of the article is misleading and does not reflect the actual content of the page. The Main Content does not explain how to get rid of toxins or what the word "toxins" in the headline refers to. The writing quality is poor, and the article includes meaningless statements such as "water therapy is one of the easiest ways of beauty regimen since it will give enough moisture on the skin". The article fails to cite sources, and there is no evidence of E-A-T.
<u>Low: Informational</u> 40th birthday party food ideas	• Unsatisfying Main Content for the purpose of the page • Ads or SC significantly distract from or interrupt the use of Main Content • Low E-E-A-T	Close observation shows Main Content that contains mostly commonly known information and poor quality writing, demonstrating a lack of effort. The Main Content is broken up by large Ads that significantly disrupt the user experience.
<u>Low: Financial</u> Page with advice on picking a quality stock for investment	• Low E-E-A-T	Advice on stock investment could significantly impact a person's financial decisions and security. This is a YMYL topic. The Main Content is superficial and includes mostly commonly known information for this topic, e.g. "look at key statistics" or "find companies with rising revenue". There is no evidence that the author has financial expertise. Because this article gives advice on a YMYL financial topic, lacking expertise is a reason for a Low rating.

Medium Page Quality

Medium pages have a beneficial purpose and achieve their purpose. There is nothing wrong with Medium quality pages.

To identify Medium quality pages, consider the following:

- **The purpose of the page:** Medium quality pages have a beneficial or non-harmful purpose.
- **The potential for the page to cause harm:** Medium quality pages are not expected to cause harm.
- **The topic of the page, the type of website, and the extent to which YMYL standards apply:** A page on any topic or any type of website may qualify for Medium.
- **The title of the page:** Medium quality pages have titles that summarize the page.
- **The role of Ads and SC:** The Ads and SC do not block or significantly interfere with the Main Content on Medium quality pages. Remember: The presence or absence of Ads is not a consideration for PQ rating.
- **Information provided by the website and content creator:** Medium quality pages have adequate information about the website and content creator for the purpose of the page. For stores or websites that process financial transactions, examine the customer service information.
- **Quality of the Main Content:** Main Content created with adequate effort, originality, talent, or skill such that the page achieves its purpose.
- **Reputation of the website and content creator:** Not especially positive nor especially negative
- **Trustworthiness of the page and E-E-A-T:** Adequate level of E-E-A-T for the purpose of the page.

There are 2 types of Medium Quality Pages

- **Nothing wrong, but nothing special:** All of the Medium Page Quality considerations and criteria apply.
- **Mixed, but with some redeeming qualities:** The page or website has some signs of High quality (E-E-A-T, quality of the Main Content, positive reputation), but also has one sign or mild signs of Low quality.

Examples of Medium Quality Pages

Webpage/Type of Content	Medium Quality Justification	Explanation
Medium: Encyclopedia Wikipedia article about baroque pearls	Nothing wrong, but nothing special • Adequate Main Content: achieves the purpose of the page	This is a short Wikipedia article about baroque pearls, a fairly narrow topic. This page achieves its purpose but doesn't display characteristics associated with a High rating, such as effort in the form of interesting and meaningful content.
Medium: Recipe Recipe for cherry-topped cake	Nothing wrong, but nothing special • Adequate Main Content: achieves the purpose of the page	This website is known for high quality content about animals and the environment. There isn't much Main Content or SC. This page achieves its purpose but it doesn't display characteristics associated with a High rating, such as effort in the form of more detailed steps or inspiration.

High Page Quality

High quality pages serve a beneficial purpose and achieve that purpose **well**.

To identify High quality pages, start by considering the following:

- **The purpose of the page:** High quality pages have a beneficial purpose.
- **The potential for the page to cause harm:** High quality pages are not expected to cause harm
- **The topic of the page, the type of website, and the extent to which YMYL standards apply:** A page on any topic or any type of website may qualify for High.
- **The title of the page:** High quality pages have helpful titles that summarize the page.
- **The role of Ads and SC on the page:** The Ads and SC do not block or significantly interfere with the Main Content on High quality pages.
- **Information provided by the website and content creator:** High quality pages have adequate information about the website and content creator. For stores or websites that process financial transactions, examine the customer service information.
- **Quality of the Main Content:** Main Content created with a high level of effort, originality, talent, or skill such that the page achieves its purpose well.
- **Reputation of the website and content creator:** Positive reputation of a website and content creator for the topic of the page. For non-YMYL topics, reputation evidence can be informal, including popularity, user engagement, and reviews. However, many smaller websites and individuals have limited reputation information available, and pages can still receive High ratings without established reputation data.
- **Trustworthiness of the page and E-E-A-T:** High level of E-E-A-T for the purpose of the page.

High Quality Main Content

High quality Main Content shows evidence of effort, originality, talent, or skill. For informational pages, High quality Main Content must be accurate and consistent with well-established expert consensus.

High Quality Main Content	Low Quality Main Content
High level of effort: The Main Content is well-organized, edited, and curated. • A news article with accuracy, depth, and clarity • A Q&A page or forum post with meaningful discussion by multiple participants	Low level of effort: The Main Content shows signs of a lack of effort by the website or content creators. • Lack of curation or editing: Content that achieves its purpose is mixed with filler content • Lack of content creation: A forum post with little discussion or only superficial comments
High originality: • The Main Content is unique or original to the website • The content on the page is unique to the content creators, such as a personal perspective based on first-hand life experience	Low originality: • Information is summarized from other sources with little added value. • Photos or videos come from other sources • A summary of the perspectives of others
High level of talent or skill: • The Main Content showcases creator's talent e.g. a video of a talented content creator dancing • The Main Content achieves its purpose well because the content creator has talent or skill, e.g. a how-to article on plumbing by a skilled plumber	Low level of talent or skill • A lack of adequate talent or skill prevents the page from achieving its purpose, e.g. a how-to article on plumbing by someone who does not have the necessary skill to explain the steps accurately

Positive reputation of the website can be a reason for a High rating if the website is responsible for the Main Content

High Quality EEAT

Depending on the purpose of the page, topic, and type of website, a high level of E-E-A-T may be required for the page to achieve its purpose well and be considered High quality.

- **Experience:** Social media posts and forum discussions are often High quality when they involve people sharing their experience. From writing symphonies to reviewing home appliances, first-hand experience can make a social media post or discussion page High quality.
- **Expertise:** required for satisfying content on a variety of topics, from hobbies such as photography to YMYL topics such as tax preparation.
- **Authoritative:** Government tax websites are an authoritative source for tax forms. Local businesses and organizations may be go-to sources for local information. When looking at a page or website, consider whether it is considered a go-to, authoritative source for the type of information it is displaying.
- **Trust** is especially important for High quality pages that involve processing financial transactions or cover YMYL topics. Even if the topic is not YMYL, trust may still be required; for example, product reviews and pages offering advice require at least some level of trust.

Examples of High Quality Pages

Webpage/Type of Content	High Quality Justification	Explanation
High: News Homepage of a newspaper	• Satisfying Main Content: achieves the purpose of the page well • Positive website reputation for the topic of the page	The news on the homepage of a newspaper is often on topics that significantly impact society. This is a YMYL topic. This is the homepage of a newspaper that has won several prestigious awards and has a positive reputation for its reporting. The articles on the page are original reporting by professional journalists.
High: Humor Article on a humor website	• Satisfying Main Content: achieves the purpose of the page well • Positive website reputation	This website is well-known for its humorous, satirical articles. This is a cute example of a satisfying and funny article (talent, skill, and original content unique to this site).
High: Blog post Parenting article about strollers	• Satisfying Main Content: achieves the purpose of the page well • Positive content creator reputation for the topic of the page • High E-E-A-T	This is a blog post on a newspaper that has won several prestigious awards. The author of this blog post has become known as an expert on parenting issues (Expertise) and is a regular contributor to this and other media websites (positive content creator reputation). The Main Content demonstrates effort and is original to this site.

Highest Quality Pages

Highest quality pages serve a beneficial purpose and achieve that purpose **very well**. The distinction between High and Highest is based on the quality of Main Content, the reputation of the website and content creator, and/or E-E-A-T.

To identify Highest quality pages, start by considering the following:

- **The purpose of the page:** Highest quality pages have a beneficial purpose.
- **The potential for the page to cause harm:** Highest quality pages are not expected to cause harm.
- **The topic of the page, the type of website, and the extent to which YMYL standards apply:** A page on any topic or any type of website may qualify for Highest.
- **The title of the page:** Highest quality pages have helpful titles that summarize the page.
- **The role of Ads and SC on the page:** The Ads and SC do not block or significantly interfere with the Main Content on Highest quality pages.
- **Information provided by the website and content creator:** Highest quality pages have adequate information about the website and content creator for the purpose of the page. For stores or websites that process financial transactions, examine the customer service information
- **Quality of the Main Content:** Main Content created with a very high level of effort, originality, talent, or skill such that the page achieves its purpose very well.
- **Reputation of the website and content creator:** Very positive reputation of the website for the topic of the page. Very positive reputation of the content creator for the topic of the Main Content.
- **Trustworthiness of the page and E-E-A-T:** Very high level of E-E-A-T for the purpose of the page.

Very High Quality Main Content

Very high quality Main Content shows evidence of a high level of effort, originality, talent, or skill. The Highest rating may be justified for pages with a very satisfying Main Content created with a very high level of effort, originality, talent, or skill.

Here are some examples of Highest quality original content:

- **For news:** Original reporting reveals previously unknown information through accurate, in-depth investigation that requires significant skill and effort. Very high quality news content cites primary sources and original reporting used during creation, while maintaining accuracy and journalistic standards.
- **For artistic content** (videos, images, photography, writing, etc.): Unique and original content created by highly skilled and talented artists or content creators. Such artistic content requires a high level of skill/talent and effort.
- **For informational content:** High-quality informational content should be original, accurate, comprehensive, and clearly communicated, reflecting expert consensus when appropriate. While expectations vary by content type (e.g., scientific papers versus social media posts), all share common traits of accuracy, clarity, and adherence to field-appropriate standards.

Very Positive Reputation

Reputation research is important for Highest ratings, with YMYL topics requiring very positive reputation based on expert recommendations, professional societies, or prestigious awards, while non-YMYL topics may rely on informal evidence like popularity, user engagement, and reviews.

Websites or content creators considered among the best sources for their topic can be viewed as having very positive reputation, though smaller websites and individuals with limited reputation information can still receive Highest ratings.

Very High Level of E-E-A-T

Very high E-E-A-T is a distinguishing factor for Highest quality pages. A website or content creator who is the uniquely authoritative, go-to source for a topic has very high E-E-A-T. A content creator with a wealth of experience may be considered to have very high E-E-A-T for topics where experience is the primary factor in trust. A very high level of expertise can justify a very high E-E-A-T assessment.

Think about what E-E-A-T means for the topic of the page. How important is first-hand experience? Who are the experts? What makes a source highly authoritative for the topic? What makes a website or content creator trustworthy for the topic? Standards for very high E-E-A-T will differ depending on the topic of the page.

Examples of Highest Quality Page

Webpage/Type of Content	Highest Quality Justification	PQ Rating and Explanation
Highest: News Article on a newspaper website	• Very satisfying Main Content • Very positive website reputation for the topic of the page • Very high E-E-A-T	This page is on a YMYL topic. Reporting on environmental toxicity can significantly impact the health and financial security of people, businesses and government agencies. This is a feature article from a newspaper that has won numerous awards. The page has a comprehensive amount of very high-quality Main Content, including in-depth reporting by authors with extensive knowledge and experience in investigative journalism.
Highest: Financial Tax forms page	• Very positive website reputation • Very high E-E-A-T	Income tax forms significantly impact a person's financial security. This is a YMYL topic. The purpose of the page is to provide income tax forms and publications. The website represents an agency of the U.S. federal government that handles taxes.
Highest: Magazine Article Article titled "Secret Fears of the Super-Rich"	• Very satisfying Main Content • Very positive website reputation	This article is on a magazine website that has won multiple National Magazine awards (very positive reputation for this type of article). The article has in-depth Main Content that is unique and original (effort, skill, original content).

Ratings for Forums and Q&A Pages

Ratings for forum and Q&A pages can be challenging. Here is some guidance on how to approach these pages:

- The Main Content **includes the question, the answers/responses, and the resulting discussions.**
- **Rate from the point of view of a user who visits the page**, rather than a participant involved in the discussion.

- **Highest quality forum/Q&A pages** have extremely satisfying conversations, including participation from users who have put a great deal of effort into their posts and have a wealth of Experience and/or Expertise on the topic. Such conversations can be very satisfying because of the depth of discussion, the unique insights, or the sharing of experiences that many would not have access to in their real-world community.
- **Low quality forum/Q&A pages** often lack effort (few responses, surface-level rather than in-depth discussion), lack Experience or Expertise, contain mild inaccuracies, or show a significant lack of respect among the participants that might deter others from joining the discussion.
- **Lowest quality forum/Q&A pages** may contain information or advice that is harmfully misleading, contradicts well-established expert consensus, encourages harm towards self or other individuals.
- *A new page or recently started discussion* that consists only of a question or initial post by a person should generally be rated **Medium** unless there are other low quality attributes. These pages may need time to achieve their purpose.
- Over time, no participation in a discussion (or only superficial discussion) and/or no meaningful answer to an open question may be a reason for a **Low** quality rating.
- If the page is a mix of high and low quality characteristics but has insightful, meaningful discussion, the **Medium** rating may be most appropriate as long as the page is not potentially harmful.

Webpage/Type of Content	Characteristics of the Page	Explanation
Lowest: Q&A page about chest pains and smoking	• Harmfully Misleading Information: Contains inaccurate and potentially dangerous medical advice about a YMYL topic	Information about chest pain and smoking could significantly impact people's decisions to seek medical treatment. This page is on a YMYL topic. The question is poorly worded and difficult to understand. There aren't many responses. The answers have incorrect and potentially dangerous medical advice, making it lowest quality Main Content.
Low: Q&A page about a 2002 Volvo part	• Unsatisfying Main Content for the purpose of the page: does not achieve the purpose well • Misleading page design	This answer is so unhelpful, we can consider this question to be unanswered. In addition to a very unhelpful "answer," the page design makes it difficult to distinguish the Main Content from Ads. For example, we see a "sponsored answer" in the same format as the real answer, but is actually an Ad.
Medium: Forum page with a new question, posted by a person	Nothing wrong, nothing special • Real in-depth question, posted very recently • No one has responded (yet)	In this case, a real person has posted a question that can lead to good discussion. For new questions, discussions and threads, a Medium rating is appropriate if there are no low quality characteristics but also no opportunity for discussion yet.
Medium: Forum page on how to wash ballet shoes	Mixed, but with some redeeming qualities: • Adequate Main Content:	This forum is about dance topics, and many pages have expertise from a community of ballet dancers. On this

	achieves the purpose of the page • Ads or SC significantly distract from or interrupt the use of Main Content • High E-E-A-T for the purpose of the page	particular page, participants have first-hand experience washing ballet shoes and make recommendations based on their own experiences. This page is “mixed” because there is some distracting content that makes it hard to read the Main Content.
<u>High: Forum post on the magic loop technique in knitting</u>	• Main Content is satisfying for the purpose of the page: demonstrates effort, originality, talent, or skill • High E-E-A-T for the purpose of the page	The person who posted the first message on this forum page provides a helpful resource on how to master the magic loop technique in knitting (effort, skill). She also shares pictures of her own version using an old pair of blue jeans (original content). With over 20 years of experience knitting socks, we would consider her to be an expert on the topic.
<u>Highest: Q&A page about how long most cancer patients live</u>	• Very satisfying Main Content: achieves the purpose of the page very well • Positive website reputation for the topic of the page • Very high E-E-A-T for the purpose of the page	How long a person may live with a disease could significantly impact life decisions. This is a YMYL topic. This is a Q&A page on a medical question that is well-answered by non-experts with life experience. There are many responses describing how long a loved one lived after diagnosis. The focus of the page is experience, not medical advice. Many responses are based on personal experience and are helpful for this topic.

Needs Met

Understanding Search Users, Queries, and Results

People use Internet search engines to perform many different tasks in different environments using different types of devices, such as mobile phones, tablets, laptops, or computers.

Keep in mind that searches can be simple or complex, and the underlying task that a person is trying to accomplish may take multiple steps to complete. Overall, search engines should make it easy for people to complete tasks by surfacing helpful results right away.

Important Rating Definitions and Ideas

User: A person who is searching. People search everywhere: people in all countries, speaking all languages; people of all ages, genders, races, religions, political affiliations, etc.

Query: The text, image and/or other content that a user enters in a search engine search box or search app to do a search. In these guidelines, queries have square brackets around them to look like a search box. If a user says “coffee shops near me,” we display: [coffee shops near me]. Queries may be spoken, typed, copied and pasted, come directly from a camera or other app, and/or be related to searches that appear in search results.

Query interpretation: The possible meaning(s) of the query or what the query may refer to. Many queries have more than one meaning. For example, the query [apple] might refer to the brand or the fruit or something else.

User Intent: What the user is trying to accomplish when they search. For example, if a user searches for a movie, they may be interested in showtimes, reviews, cast, etc. For a specific query interpretation, there may be many possible user intents. A single user may have many different intents for a single query!

Locale: All queries have a locale, which is the language and region for the task. Regions are represented by a two-letter country code, for example, "US" in the locale "English (US)". We sometimes refer to the locale as the task location.

User Location: Sometimes more specific information about the location of the person searching is provided, usually a city or state. In rating tasks, this information may be shown on a map. User location is very important for understanding the query and what results are helpful for searches related to nearby places, such as [coffee shops near me].

Search Engine Results Page (SERP): The page a search engine shows after a user enters a query in the search box. The SERP is made up of result blocks.

Result: We will use the word result to refer to the result block and the landing page.

Result Block: This is an individual “block” that appears on the user’s device in response to the query. The result block may display information in the block itself or contain links, or may do both.

The Landing Page (LP): The page you see after you click a link in the result block.

Understanding the Query

Understanding the query is the first step in evaluating the task. Think about what the user intends to do when they search for that query.

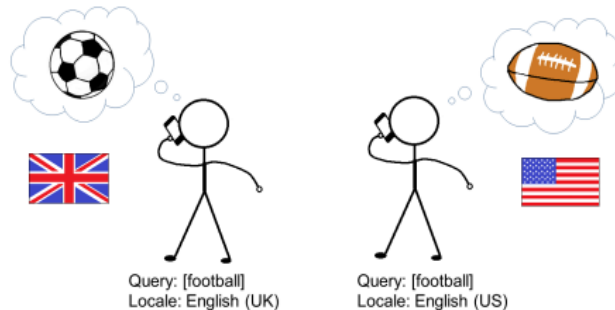
Query	User Intent
[population of paris], English (US)	Find the current population of Paris, France.
[starbucks near me], English (US)	Find the nearest Starbucks location.
[weather], English (US)	Find weather information in the user location right now.

Locale and User Location

All queries have a task language and task location (referred to in rating tasks as the "Locale"). The locale is important for understanding the query and user intent. Users in different locales may have different expectations for the same query.

For many queries in a given locale, the user location does not change our understanding of the query and user intent. Here are some examples: [kittens], [facebook.com], [distance between earth and moon].

When is the locale or user location important in understanding query interpretation and user intent? Ask yourself, "Would people in one city or country be looking for something different than people in another city or country?"



Sometimes people tell search engines exactly what kinds of results they are looking for by **adding the desired location in the query, regardless of their own location**. For example, a user located in Florida searching for [hotels in Brooklyn, NY]. The **explicit location** is the part of the query the user sometimes types to define an area of interest. In this example, the explicit location is Brooklyn, NY. When there is an explicit location in the query, pay attention to it! People use explicit locations to indicate exactly what they are looking for.

Queries with Multiple Meanings

Many queries have more than one meaning. For example, the query [apple] might refer to the computer brand or the fruit. We will call these possible meanings query interpretations.

Dominant Interpretation: The dominant interpretation of a query is what most users mean when they type the query. Not all queries have a dominant interpretation. The dominant interpretation should be clear to you, especially after doing a little web research.

Common Interpretation: A common interpretation of a query is what many or some users mean when they type a query. A query can have multiple common interpretations.

Minor Interpretation: Sometimes you will find less common interpretations. These are interpretations that fewer users have in mind. We will call these minor interpretations.

- **Reasonable minor interpretations:** Reasonable minor interpretations may help fewer users, but they still are helpful to have in a set of results because different users may want different things.
- **Unlikely minor interpretations:** An unlikely minor interpretation is an interpretation that is in theory possible but is very unlikely.
- **No chance interpretation:** An interpretation so unlikely that almost no user would have this in mind. Results for no chance interpretations feel off-topic even if they match the query words. For example, almost no one wants a result about an overheated pet for the English US query [hot dog].

Query	Reasonable query Interpretation/User Intent	Not a reasonable query interpretation or user intent
[is egg salad healthy]	To find information health information about egg salad, such as calories, fat, and protein	Recipes for egg salad (that do not include any nutritional information about egg salad) are not a reasonable minor intent for this health information search. People may be interested in recipes as a next step, but the user is specifically looking for health information, not food preparation.
[can bears climb mountains]	To look for the answer to a know-simple question about the climbing ability of bears.	Learning about mountain climbing opportunities in Bears Ears national monument is not a reasonable minor intent. Just because a result matches several key words in the query does not mean it is relevant or helpful to the user.

Query Meanings Can Change Over Time

Remember to think about the query and its current meaning as you are rating. We will assume users are looking for current information about a topic, unless otherwise specified by the query.

The interpretation of the query [iphone], English (US) has changed over time as new iPhone models are released. The first iPhone was introduced in 2007. Users searching for [iphone], English (US) at that time were looking for the new (at the time) first iPhone model. Most users now are looking for the most recent or upcoming iPhone model. In the future, new models will come out and the dominant interpretation will change again.

Understanding User Intent

It can be helpful to think of queries as having one or more of the following intents:

- **Know** query, some of which are Know Simple queries
- **Do** query, when the user is trying to accomplish a goal or engage in an activity
- **Website** query, when the user is looking for a specific website or webpage
- **Visit-in-person** query, some of which are looking for a specific business or organization, some of which are looking for a category of businesses

1. Know and Know Simple Queries

The intent of a **Know** query is to find information or explore a topic, users want to Know more about something.

Know Simple queries are a special type of Know query. Know Simple queries seek a very specific answer, like a fact, diagram, etc. This answer has to be correct and complete, and can be displayed in a relatively small amount of space.

Most queries **are not Know Simple** queries, such as:

- Broad, complex, and/or in-depth informational queries that do not have a short answer
- Ambiguous or unclear informational queries
- Informational queries on controversial topics
- Informational queries with no definitive “right answer”

Know Simple query asks for a simple fact, which can be answered correctly small amount of space, while **Know** query answer is more **complex**:

Know Simple Query	Know Query	Explanation
[new york city population 2013]	[new york city]	The Know query is a broad information query and different users may be looking for different things (e.g. trip planning, information, facts,etc.)
[macy’s store hours]	[macy’s gift wrap options]	The Know query is a broad query for a particular service offered by a department store, and does not have a short answer.

2. Do Queries

The intent of a Do query is to accomplish a goal or engage in an activity. The goal or activity may be to download, to buy, to obtain, to be entertained by, or to interact with a website or app.

Here are some examples of Do queries:

Query	User Intent
[get my GED online]	Obtain U.S. high school equivalency diploma online.
[online personality test]	Take an online personality test.
[what is my bmi?]	Calculate BMI (body mass index).

3. Website Queries

The intent of a Website query is to locate a specific website or webpage that users have requested. This single webpage is called the target of the query.

Here are some examples:

Query	Likely User Intent
[reddit login]	View the login page for Reddit.
[walmart.com]	View the Walmart website.
[feathermobility.com feather 13.5 lbs. wheelchair]	View the Feather 13.5 lbs. wheelchair product page on the Feather Chair

4. Visit-in-Person Queries and User Location

People use search engines to look for Visit-in-Person information, such as finding nearby coffee shops, gas stations, ATMs, restaurants, etc.

Some queries, though, could have both Visit-in-Person and Non-Visit-In-Person Intent. Some users may want nearby results and others may not. Here are some examples of queries with both visit-in-person and non-visit-in-person intent:

- [hotels]
- [post office]
- [h&m]
- [library]

For queries with visit-in-person intent that don't specify a location (e.g. [Chinese restaurants] with a user location of Boston, MA), results in or near the user location are the most helpful.

How close is “near”? The type of business and/or entity should be taken into consideration when deciding if the distance of the visit-in-person result is too far. For example, most people are not willing to travel very far for a gas station, coffee shop, supermarket, etc. Those are types of businesses that most users expect to find nearby. However, users might be willing to travel a little farther for certain kinds of visit-in-person results: doctors’ offices, libraries, public facilities like swimming pools, hiking trails. Sometimes users may accept results that are even farther away.

In other words, when we say users are looking for results “nearby,” the word “nearby” can mean different distances for different queries. As always, please use your judgment.

Understanding Result Blocks

Below you will find sections containing examples of different types of queries and results.

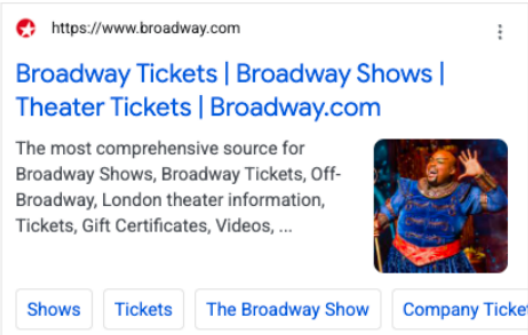
Web Search Result Blocks

Web Search Result Blocks (WSRB) typically have a title link, a URL and a “snippet” of text describing the page. For many queries, Web Search Result Blocks are the most helpful type of result.

When rating Web Search Result Block, you should evaluate the landing page to assign a rating.

Query and User Intent

Web Search Result Block

Query: [cuisinart food processor reviews] User Intent: This is a Know query. The user wants to find recent reviews of Cuisinart food processors. Result: This is a Web Search Result Block that has a link to a landing page with Cuisinart reviews	 https://www.goodhousekeeping.com > ... 9 Best Food Processors of 2022, According to Kitchen Appliance Experts - Good Housekeeping Dec 9, 2021 — Ranking at the top of our tests, this 3-cup Cuisinart is a great do-it-all size: The chop and grind functions provide versatility to mince ... Approx. \$40 to \$1,499
Query: [broadway tickets] User Intent: This is a Know query or Do query. The user wants to search prices and/or purchase tickets to a Broadway show in New York City.	 https://www.broadway.com Broadway Tickets Broadway Shows Theater Tickets Broadway.com The most comprehensive source for Broadway Shows, Broadway Tickets, Off-Broadway, London theater information, Tickets, Gift Certificates, Videos, ... Shows Tickets The Broadway Show Company Tickets

Special Content Result Blocks

Special Content Result Blocks (SCRBs) appear in the search results page, along with Web Search Result Blocks. Special Content Result Blocks are designed to show content directly to users on the search results page.

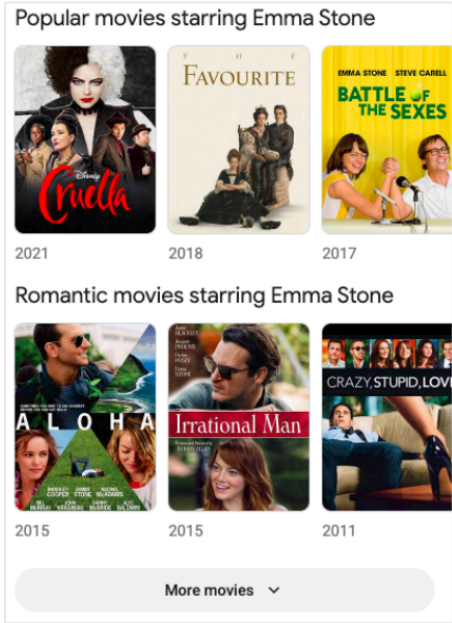
From working calculators to playable videos to interactive weather information, these results help users immediately get information or content. Some SCRBs may also have links to landing pages.

When rating, the content inside this type of block should always play a large role in your rating. Some Special Content Result Blocks may have links to landing pages. In these cases, think about whether a user would click on the link in order to satisfy their user need.

- If most users would not click, rate the Special Content Result Block based on the block content alone.
- If some or many users click, you may consider the helpfulness of the landing page(s) in addition to the content in the block. In this case, both need to be helpful to justify a high rating.

Query and User Intent

Special Content Result Block

Query: [weather] User Location: Chicago, Illinois User Intent: This is a Know Simple query since users have a fairly simple informational need. The user wants to know the weather for the User Location.	 Chicago, IL Fri, 5 PM, Snow showers 22°F °C Precip: 70% Humidity: 73% Wind: 11 mph 7 PM 12 AM 5 AM 10 AM 3 PM FRI SAT SUN MON TUE W 27° 8° 20° 15° 32° 16° 26° 17° 35° 32° 3° 2° weather.com Feedback
Query: [emma stone movies] User Intent: This is a Know query. The user wants to get information on movies with Emma Stone. Result: In this result block, users can immediately see some popular movies starring Emma Stone, with an option to click on the links to learn more about each movie. Users can also swipe to see a list of more movies.	 Popular movies starring Emma Stone Cruella 2021 Favourite 2018 Battle of the Sexes 2017 Romantic movies starring Emma Stone Aloha 2015 Irrational Man 2015 Crazy, Stupid, Love 2011 More movies ▾

Needs Met Rating Guideline

Rating Using the Needs Met Scale

Rating	Description
Fully Meets (FullyM)	A special rating category, which only applies to queries with clear intent to find one specific result and the corresponding specific result the user is looking for.
Highly Meets (HM)	A very helpful result for any dominant, common or reasonable minor query interpretation/user intent.
Moderately Meets (MM)	A helpful result for any dominant, common or reasonable minor query interpretation/user intent.

Slightly Meets (SM)	A less helpful result for a dominant, common or reasonable minor interpretation/user intent OR a helpful result for an unlikely minor query interpretation/user intent.
Fails to Meet (FailsM)	A result that completely fails to meet the needs of all or almost all users. For example, the result may be off-topic for the query or address a no chance interpretation of the query.

Landing Page Needs Met Ratings and Block Content Needs Met Ratings

In most cases, you should follow the instructions above when assigning Needs Met ratings. In some cases, though, a rating task may include special instructions that ask you to assign Landing Page Needs Met or Block Content Needs Met ratings. In these cases, follow the instructions below:

Type of Needs Met Rating	What to Rate
Landing Page Needs Met	Landing Page Needs Met ratings should be based exclusively on the landing page(s) links in the result block. This applies to both SCRBs and Web Search Result Blocks. The content that appears inside the result block should not factor into Landing Page Needs Met ratings.
Block Content Needs Met	Block Content Needs Met ratings should be based exclusively on the content inside the result block. This applies to both SCRBs and Web Search Result Blocks. Do not click through to any landing pages when rating Block Content Needs Met; landing page content should not factor into Block Content Needs Met ratings. - For Web Search Result Blocks, only consider the extent to which the page title, snippet, and any visual content within the block would directly address user need. - For SCRBs, only consider the extent to which the content within the block would directly address user needs.

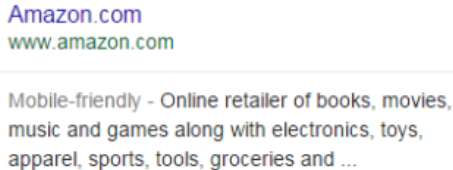
Fully Meets (FullyM)

Fully Meets is a special rating category which only applies when all of the following are true:

- The query interpretation and user intent is specific, clear, and unambiguous.
- There is a specific website, a specific webpage, a specific know-simple fact or other specific result that all or almost all users in the rating locale and user location are looking for.
- All or almost all users in the rating locale and user location would be completely satisfied by the result.

Most queries cannot have a Fully Meets result. Most queries do not specify a single website or webpage. For most queries, different people may want different types of results; for many queries, a single user may need to see many different results.

Examples of Fully Meets (FullyM) Result Blocks

Type of Query	Example	Explanation
Query: [amazon] User Intent: Go to the Amazon website.	 Amazon.com www.amazon.com Mobile-friendly - Online retailer of books, movies, music and games along with electronics, toys, apparel, sports, tools, groceries and ...	NM Rating: Fully Meets The query has clear intent to go to the amazon.com website. While there may be other interpretations for the query, the dominant one is by far the website.
Query: [new york city population 2012] User Intent: Find the population of New York City back in 2012.	 8.337 million (2012) New York City, Population 10M 5M 0 1990 2000 2010 Los Angeles 3.858 million (2012) Chicago 2.715 million (2012) Sources include: United States Census Bureau	NM Rating: Fully Meets The result block displays the complete and correct answer prominently in the result block, in a way that is easy for users to read—it Fully Meets the user need.
Query: [titanic imdb] User Intent: Go to the IMDb page for Titanic.	 Titanic - IMDb m.imdb.com/title/tt0120338/ ★★★★★ Rating: 7.7/10 - 663,660 votes Mobile-friendly - Titanic -- Experience James Cameron's Titanic like never before. Leonardo DiCaprio and Kate Winslet Titanic -- Jack ...	NM Rating: Fully Meets The query has clear intent to go to the IMDb page for Titanic.

Examples of Queries that Cannot Have Fully Meets Results

Type of Query	Example	No Fully Meets Result: Explanation
Broad queries where no single result could fully satisfy all users	[knitting]	This is a broad query. Different users may want different types of content: videos, instructions, patterns, etc. There is no one result that could satisfy most users. Therefore, no Fully Meets result is possible for this query.
	Famous names e.g., [barack obama]	This is a broad query and it is impossible to know exactly what the user is looking for.

Ambiguous queries without a clear user intent or dominant interpretation	[ada]	There is no dominant interpretation for this query. The following entities are all common interpretations: Americans with Disabilities Act, American Dental Association, and American Diabetes Association. While each interpretation has an official homepage, none is Fully Meets since there is no dominant interpretation.
	Non-famous people names e.g., [sam wen]	Queries for people's names can be tricky. Many or most people's queries do not have a dominant interpretation. Even unusual sounding name queries may not have a dominant interpretation. For example, the queries [sam wen], [tran nguyen], and [david mease] can have no Fully Meets result because there are multiple people with each of these names, and it is not clear that most users are looking for any one particular individual.

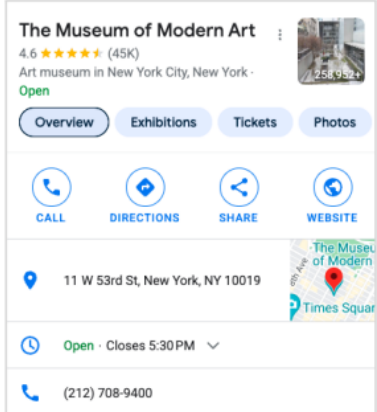
Highly Meets (HM)

A rating of Highly Meets is assigned to very helpful results for any dominant, common, or reasonable minor interpretation or user intent of the query.

Highly Meets results are highly satisfying and a good "fit" for reasonable interpretations and intents. Accuracy is required for Highly Meets informational results. Highly Meets information pages on YMYL topics must be accurate and trustworthy. Highly Meets medical and scientific information pages must represent well-established scientific/medical consensus unless the user is clearly seeking an alternative viewpoint.

A query can have many Highly Meets results. Search engines should strive to provide a diverse set of Highly Meets results from a variety of websites in a variety of content types from a variety of people and perspectives. For most queries, Highly Meets is the highest possible rating a result can receive. Results rated Highly Meets represent the most helpful content available for a given query interpretation and user intent.

Examples of Highly Meets (HM) Result Blocks

Query and User Intent	Result	Explanation
Query: [trader joes] User Location: Charlotte, North Carolina User Intent: There are two possible user intents: most users probably want to visit a nearby location or go to the website.	Trader Joe's www.traderjoes.com Mobile-friendly - Trader Joe's is a neighborhood grocery store with amazing food and drink from around the globe and around the corner ...	NM Rating: Highly Meets This is the official website for Trader Joe's, which has information on the businesses' stores, promotions, recipes, news, etc. Note: This result block is not Fully Meets because users who want information to visit the store have to do a bit of work to find that information
Query: [celine dion] User Intent: Learn more about the singer Celine Dion.	Celine Dion The Official Celine Dion Site www.celinedion.com/ Celine Dion's official website featuring Celine news, music, videos, album info and more! Videos - What's Goin' - TeamCeline account	NM Rating: Highly Meets The user intent is too broad to have a Fully Meets result. However, this is Celine Dion's official website and has a lot of content including recent news, show information, music, photos, videos, etc. This is a very helpful result
Query: [museum of modern art] User Location: Manhattan, New York User Intent: There are two possible user intents: most users probably want to visit the museum or go to the website.		NM Rating: Highly Meets The result block shows information about the museum, and is especially helpful for users who want to visit the museum. Note: This result block is not Fully Meets— even though there is a website link, it is not very satisfying for users who want to go to the website because it is not as informative as a web search result block with a title, snippet, and URL.

Moderately Meets (MM)

A rating of Moderately Meets is assigned to helpful results for any reasonable interpretation or user intent of the query, including reasonable minor interpretations and intents.

Moderately Meets results have fewer valuable attributes than Highly Meets results. Moderately Meets results should still "fit" the query, but they are less satisfying than Highly Meets results. A query can have many Moderately Meets results. Moderately Meets results exist in all formats (video, audio, text, image) and on many types of websites: professional websites, corporate websites, forums, social media, etc.

Moderately Meets is an acceptable rating if you see aspects of the result that are Highly Meets but other aspects seem Slightly Meets. There is nothing "wrong" with Moderately Meets results. Moderately Meets results are not out-of-date or inaccurate. Moderately Meets results are generally average to good.

Examples of Moderately Meets (MM) Result Blocks

Query and User Intent	Result	Explanation
Query: [emperor penguin] User intent: Find information, photos, or videos about emperor penguins.		NM Rating: Moderately Meets This is a cute short (14 second) video of a baby emperor penguin walking to a fully-grown emperor penguin. This is a helpful result for the reasonable interpretation and intent to find cute photos or videos of emperor penguins. However, the result is not very satisfying or very helpful for this query.
Query: [where is virginia in the us] User Intent: Find where the state of Virginia is located in the U.S.		NM Rating: Moderately Meets This is a helpful result for the reasonable interpretation and intent to know what states border Virginia. However, the result is not very helpful as it lacks visual information (e.g., map).
Query: [kristen wiig] User Intent: Find more information about the actress, comedian, writer, and producer.		NM Rating: Moderately Meets This is a helpful result as it is Kristen Wiig's official website. However, the result is not very helpful because there is little content and has not been updated in years.

Slightly Meets (SM)

A rating of Slightly Meets is assigned to results that have minor helpfulness for a reasonable query interpretation or user intent. A rating of Slightly Meets is also assigned to a helpful result for an unlikely query interpretation or intent.

Slightly Meets can also be an appropriate rating for a result which is related to the user's information need without fully addressing it, as long as it provides some value to the user. However, if the user is looking for a specific piece of information, a result which does not provide that information, or a result which misses a key aspect of the query, cannot be rated Slightly Meets and should be rated Fails to Meet.

Important: Many users decide which result to click or tap on based on the content in the result block, such as the title of the web result on the search results page. A result with a very misleading or exaggerated title should be rated Slightly Meets or lower.

Examples of Slightly Meets (SM) Result Blocks

Query and User Intent	Result	Explanation
Query: [britney spears] User Intent: Find information about Britney Spears (e.g., current news, pictures).	Britney Spears Files for Divorce TMZ.com www.t TMZ.com/.../britney-spears-files-for-... Nov 7, 2006 - Britney Spears has filed a petition for divorce from Kevin Federline. TMZ obtained the legal papers, ...	NM Rating: Slightly Meets The LP of this web result has a 2006 article about Britney Spears filing for divorce. This is very old, stale news, making this result less helpful for users.
Query: [hot dog] User Intent: Find information about hot dogs, such as recipes or nutrition information.	Hot Dog... The Movie (1984) - IMDb www.imdb.com/title/tt0087425/ Directed by Peter Markle. With David Naughton, Patrick Houser, Tracy Smith, John Patrick Reger. Naive corn-pone ...	NM Rating: Slightly Meets The LP of this web result is about the movie "Hot Dog," an obscure film which came out in 1984. Even though the landing page has good content, this is an unlikely minor interpretation of this query.
Query: [chase] User Intent: Most users are looking for the official Chase bank website or a nearby branch. Some users may be interested in information about the bank. User Location: Kansas City, MO	 Merriam-Webster https://www.merriam-webster.com > ... Chase Definition & Meaning 8 days ago — chase, pursue, follow, trail mean to go after or on the track of something or someone. chase implies going swiftly after and trying to overtake ...	NM Rating: Slightly Meets Most users in this locale are looking for the official Chase bank website. Very few people are looking for a definition of this common word. This is not a helpful result for most people.

Fails to Meet (FailsM)

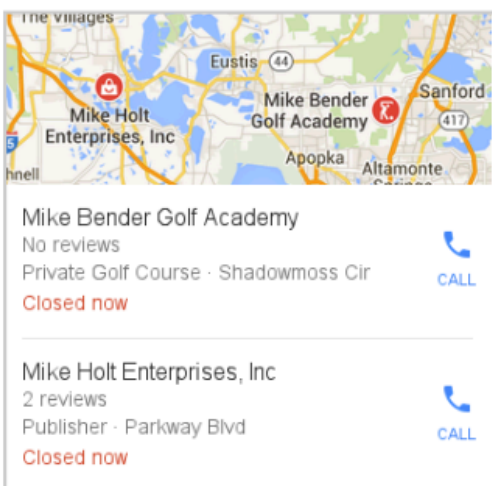
A rating of Fails to Meet should be assigned to results that fails to meet the needs of all or almost all users.

Fails to Meet results have some aspect that causes them to be unhelpful for the query, such as a lack of attention to an aspect of the query (or user location) that is critical for satisfying the user intent.

Fails to Meet may also be used for results that have incorrect, very outdated or off topic information.

Search results should never surprise people with unpleasant, upsetting, offensive, or disturbing content. For this reason, all of the following types of content should be rated Fails to Meet if it is clear that the user is not looking for such content: Harmful to Self or Other Individuals, Harmful to Specified Groups, Harmfully Misleading Information, Untrustworthy, Spammy, Porn.

Examples of Fails to Meet (FailsM) Result Blocks

Query and User Intent	Query and User Intent	Explanation
Query: [can penguins climb] User Intent: Find information about whether Penguins are able to climb or not.		NM Rating: Fails to Meet The result is about climbing a rock formation called The Penguins in the Arches National Park. This result is off-topic and does not answer the likely user intent of whether penguins can climb or not.
Query: [mike] User Location: Eustis, Florida User Intent: Find information about something related to Mike. Note: For this query, it is unlikely users want to go anywhere in person.		NM Rating: Fails to Meet This is a broad query and it is unclear exactly what the user is looking for. This result block shows visit-in-person information for two businesses that contain the name Mike. However, the query is very broad and it is very unlikely these businesses are what users seek given the query.
Query: [german cars] User Intent: Find information about German cars or go to the official homepage of a German automaker.	Subaru of America: Subaru Cars, Sedans, SUVs, Crossovers, Wagons https://www.subaru.com/ Visit Subaru of America for reviews, pricing and photos of Subaru Cars, Sedans, Wagons, Crossovers & SUVs.	NM Rating: Fails to Meet This LP is the homepage of Subaru, a Japanese car company, not a German car company. This result completely Fails to Meet the needs of the user.

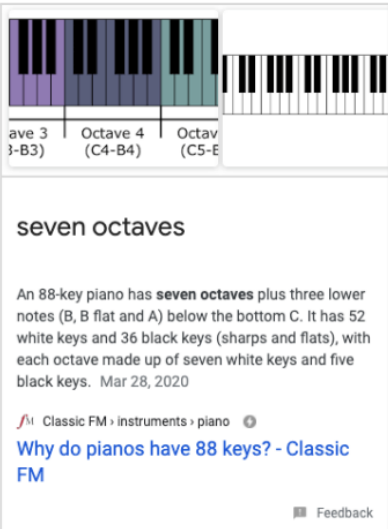
The Relationship between Page Quality and Needs Met

Needs Met rating depends on both the query and the result. Carefully think about the query and user intent when assigning a Needs Met rating. Page Quality rating, on the other hand, is completely independent of the search query - you are exclusively evaluating the quality of the page.

If a result block has no Page Quality rating slider, you do not have to give a Page Quality rating. If there is a Page Quality slider, please assign a Page Quality rating based on the landing page.

- Useless results should always be rated FailsM, even if the landing page has a high Page Quality rating. Useless is useless.
- The HM rating is not appropriate if a page is untrustworthy or has any other undesirable characteristics, such as outdated or inaccurate information.

- A page can have such low Page Quality that it is unhelpful or even harmful, such as gibberish pages or scams. These types of extremely low quality pages should be rated FailsM. (An exception is queries with clear website intent, where the target website should be rated FullyM. People are allowed to search for any website and search engines should honor that intent when it is clear.)

Query and User Intent	Result Block and LP, NM Rating, PQ	Explanation
Query: [symptoms of dehydration] User Intent: Find information about the symptoms of dehydration.	Symptoms of Dehydration www.symptomsofdehydration.com/ What are the symptoms of dehydration? Learn about the signs you can expect when dehydration begins and also as it ...	Needs Met: FailsM Even though the article is topical, the information is not trustworthy and is potentially misleading or harmful. This result is unhelpful for the query. Page Quality: Lowest This is a YMYL topic. This page has no evidence of medical expertise/authority and is not trustworthy
Query: [how many octaves on a guitar] User Intent: Find out the number of octaves on a guitar.		Needs Met: Fails to Meet This block shows the number of octaves on a piano, not a guitar. Even though this block has a link to a high quality landing page about pianos, the information shown in the block is inaccurate with respect to the query. This result Fails to Meet the user need. Page Quality: High There is a lot of helpful Main Content on the landing page. The page has medium to high E-E-A-T. Medium+ to High is an appropriate rating.

Rating Porn, Foreign Language, and Did Not Load Results

You will be asked to assign Porn, Foreign Language, and Did Not Load flags to result blocks when appropriate. Some rating tasks may also ask you to identify Upsetting-Offensive and/or Not-for-Everyone results. All flags should be assigned based on the result alone and do not depend on the query.

Porn Flag

The Porn flag is used to indicate that the result is porn. It doesn't matter whether the query "asks for porn". Please assign the Porn flag to all porn pages, whether the query is porn-seeking or not. The Porn flag does not depend on the query or user intent. This flag should be used if the content inside the result block, or the content on the LP, is pornographic, including images, links, text, pop-ups, and/or porn ads.

- Needs Met Rating for Clear Non-Porn Intent Queries

If the user intent is clearly not porn-seeking, a landing page that has porn for its Main Content should be rated Fails to Meet.

The following queries should be considered non-porn intent queries: [girls], [wives], [mature women], [gay people], [people kissing], [boy speedos], [moms and sons], [pictures of girls], [pictures of women], [cheerleaders], etc.

- Needs Met Rating for Possible Porn Intent Queries

Some queries have both non-porn and porn interpretations. For example, the following English (US) queries have both a non-porn and an erotic or porn interpretation: [breast], [sex]. We will call these queries “possible porn intent” queries. For “possible porn intent” queries, please rate as if the non-porn interpretation were dominant, even though some or many users may be looking for porn.

Query	User Intent	Landing Page	Rating	Porn flag?
[breasts], English (US)	Find anatomy or health information about breasts.	Example	HM	No
		Example Warning - this page is porn	FailsM	Yes

- Needs Met Rating for Clear Porn Intent Queries

For very clear porn intent queries, assign a rating to the porn landing page based on how helpful it is for the user. Even though there is porn intent, the page should still be assigned a Porn flag. Do not simply rate all porn pages for porn queries as MM or HM. Even though the query is porn and the result is porn, the page must fit the query and be helpful to get a high Needs Met rating.

Pages that provide a poor user experience, such as pages that try to download malicious software, should receive low ratings.

Foreign Flag

Please do not assign the Foreign Language flag when the language on the landing page is one of the following:

- The task language
- A language that is commonly used by a significant percentage of the population in the task location
- English

For example, most Catalan-speaking users in Spain also speak Spanish. Therefore, for rating tasks in Catalan (ES), the Foreign Language flag should NOT be assigned to landing pages in Catalan, Spanish, or English.

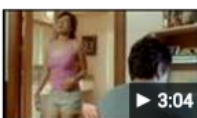
Important:

- Please assign the Foreign Language flag based on the language of the landing page, not the result block
- Please remember to flag all foreign pages with the Foreign Language flag, even if most users in your locale would expect or want a foreign language page for the query

- Needs Met Rating for Foreign Language Results

In **most cases**, pages you flag as **Foreign Language** should be rated **FailsM**, because they cannot be understood by most users in your locale and are therefore useless. Remember that if users in your locale can read the language, then you shouldn't be using the Foreign Language flag.

Occasionally, you will encounter helpful **Foreign Language** pages. If the query clearly indicates that **most users would expect or want a foreign language result**, then the Needs Met rating of the foreign language page **should not be FailsM**.

Query and User Intent	Result Block and Landing Page	Explanation
Query: [baidu] Locale: English (US) User Intent: Go to the Baidu website.	百度 www.baidu.com/ 移动版适用 - 主要提供网页、音乐、图片、新闻搜索, 同时有贴吧和WAP搜索功能。	NM Rating: Fully Meets Flag: Foreign Flag This LP is the homepage of the Baidu website. The result is the target page of the query, but is in a foreign language (Chinese).
Query: [video of celine dion singing s'il suffisait d'aimer] Locale: English (US) User Intent: Watch a video of Celine Dion singing this song.	Celine Dion - S'il Suffisait D'aimer Live - YouTube  YouTube app Sep 2, 2011 Open on youtube.com	NM Rating: Highly Meets Flag: N/A This video is just what English (US) users are looking for, even if the video is not in English. The language of the LP is mostly English (even though the video is in French), so the Foreign Language flag is not needed.
Query: [kasal, kasali, kasalo] Locale: English (US) User Intent: Watch a trailer of this Filipino film or find information about it.	Kasal Kasalo Kasali - YouTube  m.youtube.com/watc... Apr 8, 2007	NM Rating: Moderately Meets Flag: Foreign Flag The query is for a Filipino film. The LP is a clip from the movie in Filipino (Tagalog). It would be helpful for many English (US) users who type the query, even though it is not in English.

Did Not Load Flag

Did Not Load is used to indicate technical problems with the webpage that prevent users from viewing any LP content.

Use the Did Not Load flag when:

- The Main Content of the landing page is a web server or web application error message and there is no other content on the page (no navigation links, home link, SC, nor Ads). See [here](#) for a Wikipedia page on different types of error messages.
- The landing page is completely blank: no Main Content, no SC, and no Ads.

You should not use the Did Not Load flag for:

- Malware warnings, such as "Warning – visiting this site may harm your computer!" ([example](#)).
- Pages that have removed or expired Main Content (e.g., expired classified listing, removed social media post, products or services unavailable).
- Pages that are inaccessible because you need a subscription to view the Main Content.

Assign the Did Not Load flag based on the landing page, not the result block. If the landing page truly doesn't load, assign the Did Not Load flag and rate the page FailsM. If you are unable to evaluate the Page Quality rating of a Did Not Load result, you do not need to assign a Page Quality rating

Query and User Intent	Result Block and LP	Explanation
Query: [boys pink snow shoes] User Intent: Find information about or purchase boys' snow shoes.	Boys' Snow Boots & Winter Socks Nordstrom m.shop.nordstrom.com › Kids › Boys Mobile-friendly - Shop online for boys' snow boots & winter socks at Nordstrom.com. Browse cold-weather boots, waterproof boots ...	Needs Met: Fails to Meet Page Quality: High Flag: N/A The Main Content has an error message, but the LP has a lot of SC. However, the page has no information about boys' pink snow shoes and is unhelpful for the query. This LP is on a well-known, reputable merchant website. Despite the error message, this page does a nice job of explaining the issue and providing a search box, including helpful search tips and customer service information.
Query: [paranormal activity] User Intent: Learn more about the 2007 film Paranormal Activity or the associated film series	https://paranormalhangout.com › ... Paranormal Activity Discussion Board Welcome to our Paranormal Activity discussion board! Come discuss the film, the series, or your own personal encounters with paranormal ...	Needs Met: Fails to Meet Page Quality: N/A Flag: Did Not Load This page cannot be reached because the site's server IP address was not found. There is no Main Content, SC, or Ads on the page. This result merits a FailsM Needs Met rating, and no Page Quality rating is required.

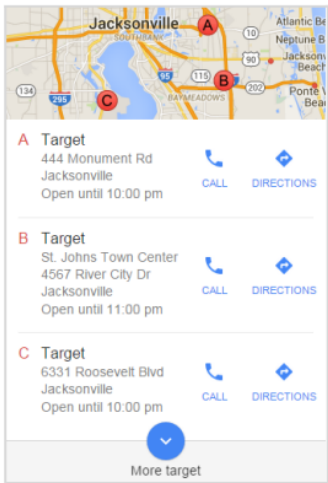
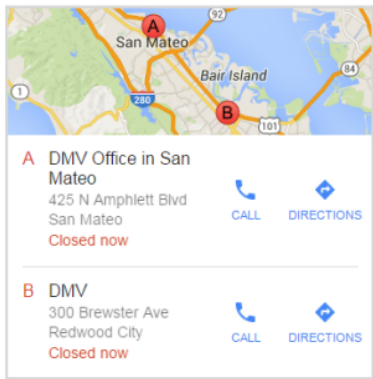
Rating Queries with Both Website and Visit-in-Person Intent

Some queries have two possible strong intents:

1. **Go to the website** intent: for example, to find out information, buy something online, make a reservation, schedule an appointment, or interact with customer support
2. **Visit-in-person** intent: user wants to visit the store, business, etc. in person

For these queries, result blocks that only satisfy one intent should NOT get a Fully Meets rating.

Query and User Intent	Result Block and LP	Needs Met Rating and Explanation
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Query: [target] User Location: Jacksonville, Florida User Intent: There are two possible strong user intents: most users probably want to visit a nearby Target location or go to the website to shop online, research products, find prices, etc	 Target m.target.com Mobile-friendly - ... with \$25 purchase or free same day store pickup on all online orders ... Search target.com	NM Rating: Highly Meets+ The result block shows three popular Target locations in Jacksonville, with information that is especially helpful for users who want to visit the store. This fulfills the user intent to find a nearby Target location.
Query: [dmv] User Location: Belmont, California User Intent: There are two possible strong user intents: most users probably want to visit a nearby DMV location or go to the DMV website to renew a license, pay a fee, find some information, etc.	 DMV - State of California https://www.dmv.ca.gov California DMV Home Page is available for customers to check out publications, download forms, brochures, FAQs, ...	NM Rating: Highly Meets+ The result block shows two nearby DMV locations, with information that is especially helpful for users who want to visit the locations. This fulfills the user intent to find a nearby DMV location.

Needs Met Rating and Freshness

Some queries demand very recent or “fresh” information. Users may be looking for “breaking news,” such as an important event or natural disaster happening right now. Here are different types of queries demanding current/recent results.

Type of Query	Example Queries	Explanation
“Breaking news”	[tornado], [tsunami]	Assume users need the information right away.

queries		Imagine someone who needs immediate weather information because a big storm is coming. Information about last year's weather would not be helpful.
Recurring event queries, such as elections, sports events, TV shows, conferences, etc.	[olympics], [american idol], [redsox schedule], [tax forms], [elections]	Assume users are looking for the most recent or current information about the event. For example, if the Olympics are happening right now, users searching [olympics] want information about the current Olympics, not results from years ago. If the next Olympics are a few months away, users are probably interested in the upcoming Olympics.
Current information queries	[population of paris], [amount of u.s. debt], [airfare from ny to sfo]	Assume users are looking for the most current information, such as prices or airfare.
Product queries	[iphone], [toyota camry], [windows operating system]	Assume users are looking for information about the most recent model/version for these product queries.

For queries requiring recent information, only current and updated pages should receive high Needs Met ratings, while outdated or "stale" content about past events, old products, or obsolete information should get low ratings or even **FailsM** in some cases.

Some queries may have both recent and timeless user intent, such as searches for celebrities that could seek either biographical information or latest news.

However, freshness is less critical for Page Quality ratings—archival content from reputable sources can still score high, though unmaintained or inaccurate old websites warrant low ratings. It's important to note that the displayed date may reflect when content was last updated rather than when the page was created, and some sites always show the current date regardless of actual updates.

Misspelled and Mistyped Queries

You will notice that some queries are misspelled or mistyped. For example, [federal expres] - the reasonable query interpretation is "Federal Express."

Some misspelled or mistyped queries are more difficult to interpret. Use your judgment and do query research.

For **obviously misspelled or mistyped queries**, you should **base your rating on user intent**, not necessarily on exactly how the query has been spelled or typed by the user.

For queries that are **not obviously misspelled or mistyped**, you should **respect the query as written**, and assume users are looking for results for the query as it is spelled.

Consider the query [john stuart], English (US). There is a very famous Jon Stewart, the comedian and former host of a popular U.S. television show. However, we should not assume that the query [john stuart] has been misspelled. There are many people named John Stuart. We will respect the query as written and assume the user is looking for someone named “John Stuart.”

Rating Dictionary and Encyclopedia Results for Different Queries

When rating dictionary and encyclopedia results, user intent must be carefully considered, as the helpfulness of these resources depends heavily on the query and what users are seeking.

While dictionary and encyclopedia entries may be topically relevant for many searches, they are often not helpful for common words that most people in the rating locale already understand, and high Needs Met ratings should be reserved only for queries with clear "what is it" or "what does it mean" intent. For very common words where most people likely know the meaning and more reasonable intents exist, a **Slightly Meets** rating may be more appropriate than a high rating, even if the result is technically relevant.

Query and User Intent	Result Block and LP	Explanation
Query: [obsequious] User Intent: Users are probably looking for the definition of this vocabulary word.	 Merriam-Webster › dictionary › obs... Obsequious Definition of Obsequious by Merriam-Webster Obsequious definition is - marked by or exhibiting a fawning attentiveness. How to use obsequious in a sentence. Follow Along With the ...	Needs Met Rating: Highly Meets This is a vocabulary word often studied in secondary school and found on college entrance exams. Many users may be looking for a definition and would find this dictionary result helpful.
Query: [cafeteria] User Location: Eugene, Oregon User Intent: Most English-speaking users in the US are familiar with cafeterias. Users are most likely looking for a place to eat.	 Wikipedia › wiki › Automated_telle... Automated teller machine - Wikipedia Jump to History · On September 2, 1969, Chemical Bank installed the first ATM in the U.S. at its branch in Rockville Centre, New York. The first ATMs were designed to dispense a fixed amount of cash when a user inserted a specially coded card. Location Financial networks Global use Hardwar	Needs Met Rating: Slightly Meets The user wants to learn more information about the history of ATM machines. This encyclopedia article includes an extensive section on ATM machine history. This is a very helpful result.

Duplicate Results

In some rating tasks, you may be asked to determine whether any results are Duplicates (dupes). This section provides guidance and examples of how to report duplicate results In Needs Met (NM) rating tasks.

Pre-identified Duplicates: Some duplicate results are automatically detected and will be pre-identified for you.

Left Side	Right side
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L2 - Same as R2. - select dupes THE 10 BEST Charlotte Hotels with a Pool of 2019 (with Prices ... https://www.tripadvisor.com > ... > North Carolina (NC) > Charlotte > Charlotte Hotels ▾ Best Charlotte Hotels with a Swimming Pool on TripAdvisor: Find 26846 traveler reviews, 10310 candid photos, and prices for 116 hotels with a swimming pool ...	R2 - Same as L2. - select dupes THE 10 BEST Charlotte Hotels with a Pool of 2019 (with Prices ... https://www.tripadvisor.com > ... > North Carolina (NC) > Charlotte > Charlotte Hotels ▾ Best Charlotte Hotels with a Swimming Pool on TripAdvisor: Find 26846 traveler reviews, 10310 candid photos, and prices for 116 hotels with a swimming pool ...
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Rater-Identified Duplicates: You are also asked to help identify duplicate results that have not been automatically detected. Please mark two results as dupes if they have essentially the same content on the main landing page AND you would not want a search engine to return both results for the query.

Please note that it is query dependent

- **For Specific Queries** (e.g. song lyrics, queries looking for a specific article, etc.) obtaining that content from different sites could be helpful to verify the information, so they should **not be rated as dupes**.
- **For Broad Queries**, results may be considered dupes even if they have minor content differences on the page (such as different ads, images, or related links).

Reporting Duplicate Results: When you notice that the results in two or more result blocks are duplicates, please click on the Select Dupe link at the top of one of the results (which will be highlighted in red).

R5 - finish selecting dupes

HOUSTON ZOO – NATURALLY WILD - Home
www.houstonzoo.org/
 Features information and pictures on the different animals as well as zoo hours, facility map, classes and programs, and ...
 4.5 ★★★★★ 290 reviews

Needs Met Rating

N/A FailsM SM MM HM FullyM

Porn: No Foreign Language: No Did Not Load: No [Comment](#)

Then select the block that are duplicates (which will be highlighted in yellow)

L2 - Dupe of R5: No

HOUSTON ZOO – NATURALLY WILD - Home
www.houstonzoo.org/
 Features information and pictures on the different animals as well as zoo hours, facility map, classes and programs, and ...
 4.5 ★★★★★ 290 reviews

Needs Met Rating

N/A FailsM SM MM HM FullyM

Porn: No Foreign Language: No Did Not Load: No [Comment](#)

Once done selecting all dupes, you can click “finish selecting dupes”